



EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL OF ESWATINI
Eswatini General Certificate of Secondary Education

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

6875/01

Paper 1 (Set Texts: Closed Books)

October/November 2025

2 hours 15 minutes

Additional Materials: Answer booklet/paper
 As listed in instructions to Supervisors

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

If you have been given an answer booklet, follow the instructions on the front cover of the booklet.
Write your Centre number, candidate number and name on all the work you hand in.
Write in dark blue or black pen.
Do **not** use staples, paper clips, highlighters, glue or correction fluid.

Answer **three** questions: **one** question from Section A (Drama), **one** question from Section B (Poetry) and **one** question from Section C (Prose).

At least one of these must be a passage-based question (marked*) and **at least one** must be an essay/empathic question.

At the end of the examination, fasten all your work securely together.

All questions are worth equal marks.
The total mark for this paper is 60.

This document consists of **17** printed pages and **3** blank pages.

CONTENTS

SECTION A: DRAMA

Texts		Question No.	Page(s)
J. B. Priestley	<i>An Inspector Calls</i>	*1, 2, 3	4–5
William Shakespeare	<i>Twelfth Night</i>	*4, 5, 6	6–7
Lorraine Hansberry	<i>A Raisin in the Sun</i>	*7, 8, 9	8–9

SECTION B: POETRY

Jack Hydes (ed.)	<i>Touched with Fire: Section B: The light of setting suns</i>	*10, 11, 12	10
Brian Walter and Felicity Wood (eds.)	<i>Groundwork: An Introduction to Reading and Writing about Poetry</i>	*13, 14, 15	11
Elise Varga (ed.)	<i>Unbroken Chains: An Anthology of Poetry</i>	*16, 17, 18	12

SECTION C: PROSE

Harper Lee	<i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	*19, 20, 21	14–15
Chinua Achebe	<i>Things Fall Apart</i>	*22, 23, 24	16–17
Barrie Wade (ed.)	<i>Into the Wind: Contemporary Stories in English</i>	*25, 26, 27	18–19

TURN OVER FOR SECTION A

SECTION A: DRAMA

Answer **one** question from this section.

J.B. PRIESTLEY: *An Inspector Calls*

Either

- *1 What impressions do you form of Eric's personality in the passage? Support your answer with close reference to the passage.

Birling:	[to ERIC] All right. Go on.	
	[ERIC goes for a whisky. His whole manner of handling the decanter and then the drink shows his familiarity with quick heavy drinking. The others watch him narrowly.]	
	[Bitterly] I understand a lot of things now I didn't understand before.	
Inspector:	Don't start on that. I want to get on. [To ERIC.] When did you first meet this girl?	5
Eric:	One night last November.	
Inspector:	Where did you meet her?	
Eric:	In the Palace bar. I'd been there an hour or so with two or three chaps. I was a bit squiffy.	10
Inspector:	What happened then?	
Eric:	I began talking to her, and stood her a few drinks. I was rather far gone by the time we had to go.	
Inspector:	Was she drunk too?	
Eric:	She told me afterwards that she was a bit, chiefly because she'd not had much to eat that day.	15
Inspector:	Why had she gone there – ?	
Eric:	She wasn't the usual sort. But – well, I suppose she didn't know what to do. There was some woman who wanted her to go there. I never quite understood about that.	20
Inspector:	You went with her to her lodgings that night?	
Eric:	Yes, I insisted – it seems. I'm not very clear about it, but afterwards she told me she didn't want me to go in but that – well, I was in that state when a chap easily turns nasty – and I threatened to make a row.	
Inspector:	So she let you in?	25
Eric:	Yes. And that's when it happened. And I didn't even remember – that's the hellish thing. Oh – my God! – how stupid it all is!	
Mrs Birling:	[with a cry] Oh – Eric – how could you?	
Birling:	[sharply] Sheila, take your mother along to the drawing-room –	
Sheila:	[protesting] But – I want to –	30
Birling:	[very sharply] You heard what I said. [Gentler.] Go on, Sybil.	
	[He goes to open the door while SHEILA takes her mother out. Then he closes it and comes in.]	
Inspector:	When did you meet her again?	
Eric:	About a fortnight afterwards.	35
Inspector:	By appointment?	
Eric:	No. And I couldn't remember her name or where she lived. It was all very vague. But I happened to see her again in the Palace bar.	
Inspector:	More drinks?	
Eric:	Yes, though that time I wasn't so bad.	40

Inspector: But you took her home again?
 Eric: Yes. And this time we talked a bit. She told me something about herself and I talked too. Told her my name and what I did.
 Inspector: And you made love again?
 Eric: Yes. I wasn't in love with her or anything – but I liked her – she was pretty and a good sport – 45
 Birling: [*harshly*] So you had to go to bed with her?
 Eric: Well, I'm old enough to be married, aren't I, and I'm not married, and I hate these fat old tarts round the town – the ones I see some of your respectable friends with – 50
 Birling: [*angrily*] I don't want any of that talk from you –
 Inspector: [*very sharply*] I don't want any of it from either of you. Settle it afterwards. [*To ERIC.*] Did you arrange to see each other after that?
 Eric: Yes. And the next time – or the time after that – she told me that she thought she was going to have a baby. She wasn't quite sure. And then she was. 55

Or

- 2 'Priestley's play shows a world in which members of the older generation do not take responsibility for their actions.' To what extent do you agree with this statement? Support your answer with close reference to the play.

Or

- 3 You are Birling, just after the Inspector has left your house. Write your thoughts.

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE: *Twelfth Night*

Either

- *4 What do you think the following passage reveals about the personality of Malvolio and his attitude towards other people? Support your answer with close reference to the passage.

	[Enter MALVOLIO]	
Malvolio:	'Tis but fortune; all is fortune. Maria once told me she did affect me; and I have heard herself come thus near that, should she fancy, it should be one of my complexion. Besides she uses me with a more exalted respect than anyone else that follows her. What should I think on't?	5
Sir Toby:	Here's an overweening rogue.	
Fabian:	O, peace! Contemplation makes a rare turkey-cock of him; how he jets under his advanced plumes.	
Sir Andrew:	'Slight, I could so beat the rogue!	
Sir Toby:	Peace, I say.	10
Malvolio:	To be Count Malvolio.	
Sir Toby:	Ah, rogue!	
Sir Andrew:	Pistol him, pistol him.	
Sir Toby:	Peace, peace.	
Malvolio:	There is example for't; the lady of the Strachy married the yeoman of the wardrobe.	15
Sir Andrew:	Fie on him, Jezebel!	
Fabian:	O, peace. Now he's deeply in; look how imagination blows him.	
Malvolio:	Having been three months married to her, sitting in my state –	
Sir Toby:	O, for a stone-bow, to hit him in the eye.	20
Malvolio:	Calling my officers about me, in my branched velvet gown; having come from a day-bed, where I have left Olivia sleeping –	
Sir Toby:	Fire and brimstone!	
Fabian:	O, peace, peace.	
Malvolio:	And then to have the humour of state; and after a demure travel of regard, telling them I know my place as I would they should do theirs, to ask for my kinsman Toby –	25
Sir Toby:	Bolts and shackles!	
Fabian:	O peace, peace, peace. Now, now.	
Malvolio:	Seven of my people with an obedient start make out for him. I frown the while, and perchance wind up my watch, or play with my – some rich jewel. Toby approaches; courtesies there to me –	30
Sir Toby:	Shall this fellow live?	
Fabian:	Though our silence be drawn from us with cars, yet peace.	
Malvolio:	I extend my hand to him thus, quenching my familiar smile with an austere regard of control –	35
Sir Toby:	And does not Toby take you a blow o' the lips then?	
Malvolio:	Saying, 'Cousin Toby, my fortunes having cast me on your niece give me this prerogative of speech' –	
Sir Toby:	What, what?	40
Malvolio:	'You must amend your drunkenness.'	
Sir Toby:	Out, scab!	
Fabian:	Nay, patience, or we break the sinew of our plot.	
Malvolio:	'Besides, you waste the treasure of your time with a foolish knight' –	
Sir Andrew:	That's me, I warrant you.	45
Malvolio:	'One Sir Andrew' –	

Sir Andrew:	I knew 'twas I, for many do call me fool.	
Malvolio:	[<i>Seeing the letter</i>] What employment have we here?	
Fabian:	Now is the woodcock near the gin.	
Sir Toby:	O, peace. And the spirit of humours intimate reading aloud to him.	50
Malvolio:	[<i>Taking up the letter</i>] By my life, this is my lady's hand: these be her very C's, her U's and her T's, and thus makes she her great P's. It is in contempt of question her hand.	
Sir Andrew:	Her C's, her U's, and her T's. Why that –	
Malvolio:	[<i>Reads</i>] 'To the unknown beloved, this, and my good wishes.' Her very phrases. By your leave, wax. Soft – and the impressure her Lucrece, with which she uses to seal. 'Tis my lady. To whom should this be?	55
Fabian:	This wins him, liver and all.	
Malvolio:	[<i>Reads</i>] 'Jove knows I love, But who? Lips do not move; No man must know.' 'No man must know.' What follows? The numbers altered. 'No man must know.' If this should be thee, Malvolio?	60
Sir Toby:	Marry, hang thee, brock!	65
Malvolio:	[<i>Reads</i>] 'I may command where I adore; But silence, like a Lucrece knife, With bloodless stroke my heart doth gore; M. O. A. I. doth sway my life.'	70

Or

- 5 How does Shakespeare dramatically convey ways in which people desire what they cannot have? Support your answer with close reference to the play.

Or

- 6 You are Antonio, having just discovered that you have mistaken Viola for Sebastian. Write your thoughts.

LORRAINE HANSBERRY: *A Raisin in the Sun*

Either

- *7 What do you think the following passage reveals about the personalities of Asagai and Beneatha and the way they relate to each other? Support your answer with close reference to the passage.

[They go out, RUTH's weight on her mother-in-law. BENEATHA, herself profoundly disturbed, opens the door to admit a rather dramatic-looking young man with a large parcel.]

- Asagai: Hello, Alaiyo –
- Beneatha: *[holding the door open and regarding him with pleasure]* Hello ... *[Long pause.]* 5
Well – come in. And please excuse everything. My mother was very upset about my letting anyone come here with the place like this.
- Asagai: *[coming into the room]* You look disturbed too ... Is something wrong?
- Beneatha: *[still at the door, absently]* Yes ... we've all got acute ghetto-itis.
[She smiles and comes towards him, finding a cigarette and sitting] So – 10
sit down! How was Canada?
- Asagai: *[a sophisticate]* Canadian.
- Beneatha: *[looking at him]* I'm very glad you are back.
- Asagai: *[looking back at her in turn]* Are you really?
- Beneatha: Yes – very. 15
- Asagai: Why – you were quite glad when I went away. What happened?
- Beneatha: You went away.
- Asagai: Ahhhhhhhhhh.
- Beneatha: Before – you wanted to be so serious before there was time.
- Asagai: How much time must there be before one knows what one feels? 20
- Beneatha: *[stalling this particular conversation. Her hands pressed together, in a deliberate childish gesture]* What did you bring me?
- Asagai: *[handing her the parcel]* Open it and see.
- Beneatha: *[eagerly opening the package and drawing out some records and the colourful robes of a Nigerian woman]* Oh, Asagai! ... You got them for me! ... How 25
beautiful ... and the records too! *[She lifts out the robes and runs to the mirror with them and holds the drapery up in front of herself]*
- Asagai: *[coming to her at the mirror]* I shall have to teach you how to drape it properly.
[He flings the material about her for the moment and stands back to look at her] 30
Ah – Oh-pay-gay-day, oh-gbah-mu-shay *[a Yoruba exclamation for admiration]*
You wear it well...very well ... mutilated hair and all.
- Beneatha: *[turning suddenly]* My hair – what's wrong with my hair?
- Asagai: *[shrugging]* Were you born like that?
- Beneatha: *[reaching up to touch it]* No ... of course not. *[She looks back at the mirror, disturbed]* 35
- Asagai: *[smiling]* How then?
- Beneatha: You know perfectly well how ... as crinkly as yours ... that's how.
- Asagai: And it is ugly to you that way?
- Beneatha: *[quickly]* Oh, no – not ugly ... *[More slowly, apologetically]* But it's so hard to 40
manage when it's, well – raw.
- Asagai: And so to accommodate that – you mutilate it every week?
- Beneatha: It's not mutilation!
- Asagai: *[laughing aloud at her seriousness]* Oh ... please! I am only teasing you 45
because you are so serious about these things *[He stands back from her and folds his arms across his chest as he watches her pulling at her hair and frowning in the mirror]* Do you remember the first time you met me at school?

... [*He laughs*] You came up to me and you said – and I thought you were the most serious little thing I had ever seen – you said: [*he imitates her*] ‘Mr Asagai – I want very much to talk with you. About Africa. You see, Mr Asagai – I am looking for my *identity!*’ [*He laughs*]. 50

Beneatha: [*turning to him, not laughing*] Yes – [*Her face is quizzical, profoundly disturbed*].
 Asagai: [*still teasing and reaching out and taking her face in his hands and turning her profile to him*] Well ... it is true that this is not so much a profile of a Hollywood queen as perhaps a queen of the Nile – [*A mock dismissal of the importance of the question*] But what does it matter? Assimilationism is so popular in your country. 55

Or

- 8 Show in what ways the importance of family and morality to Mama are made so dramatically vivid. Support your answer with close reference to the play.

Or

- 9 You are Ruth and you have just heard that Walter has given away all the money for the business. Write your thoughts.

SECTION B: POETRY

Answer **one** question from this section.

JACK HYDES (ed.): *Touched with Fire: Section B: 'The light of setting suns'*

Either

- *10** How do you think the words of the poet W. H. Auden vividly portray the impact of suffering on humankind? Support your answer with close reference to the poem.

Musée des Beaux Arts

About suffering they were never wrong, The Old Masters: how well they understood Its human position; how it takes place While someone else is eating or opening a window or just walking dully along;	5
How, when the aged are reverently, passionately waiting For the miraculous birth, there always must be Children who did not specially want it to happen, skating On a pond at the edge of the wood: They never forgot	10
That even the dreadful martyrdom must run its course Anyhow in a corner, some untidy spot Where the dogs go on with their doggy life and the torturer's horse Scratches its innocent behind on a tree.	15
In Brueghel's <i>Icarus</i> , for instance: how everything turns away Quite leisurely from the disaster; the ploughman may Have heard the splash, the forsaken cry, But for him it was not an important failure; the sun shone As it had to on the white legs disappearing into the green Water; and the expensive delicate ship that must have seen Something amazing, a boy falling out of the sky, Had somewhere to get to and sailed calmly on.	20

Or

- 11** Explore how Philip Larkin conveys thoughts about churches and religion in the poem *Church Going*. Support your answer with close reference to the poem.

Or

- 12** Choose **one** of the following poems and explore how the poet makes it memorable for you.
- *Little Boy Crying* by Mervin Morris
 - *Two Look at Two* by Robert Frost

BRIAN WALTER and FELICITY WOOD (eds.):
Groundwork: An Introduction to Reading and Writing about Poetry

Either

- *13** Explore how the words of the poet Alfred Tennyson vividly convey the pain of loss and separation. Support your answer with close reference to the poem.

Break, Break, Break

Break, break, break,
 On thy cold gray stones, O Sea!
 And I would that my tongue could utter
 The thoughts that arise in me.

O, well for the fisherman's boy,
 That he shouts with his sister at play!
 O, well for the sailor lad,
 That he sings in his boat on the bay!

5

And the stately ships go on
 To their haven under the hill;
 But O for the touch of a vanished hand,
 And the sound of a voice that is still!

10

Break, break, break,
 At the foot of thy crags, O Sea!
 But the tender grace of a day that is dead
 Will never come back to me.

15

Or

- 14** Choose one of the following poems and discuss how the poet's presentation of the situation affects you.
- *The Blues is You in Me* by Sipho Sepamla
 - *First Day After the War* by Mazisi Kunene

Or

- 15** 'With close reference to the language and style of **either** *Song* by Federico Garcia Lorca or *African Grass* by Shimmer Chinodya, explore how the poet teaches powerful life lessons.

ELISE VARGA (ed.): *Unbroken Chains: An Anthology of Poetry*

Either

- *16 Explore how the poet William Shakespeare uses powerful language to describe a painful situation in this poem. Support your answer with close reference to the poem.

Sonnet 141

In faith, I do not love thee with mine eyes,
 For they in thee a thousand errors note,
 But 'tis my heart that loves what they despise,
 Who in despite of view is pleased to dote.
 Nor are mine ears with thy tongue's tune delighted, 5
 Nor tender feeling to base touches prone,
 Nor taste, nor smell, desire to be invited
 To any sensual feast with thee alone.
 But my five wits nor my five senses can 10
 Dissuade one foolish heart from serving thee,
 Who leaves unswayed the likeness of a man,
 Thy proud heart's slave and vassal wretch to be:
 Only my plague thus far I count my gain,
 That she that makes me sin awards me pain.

Or

- 17 Explore the ways in which the poet creates a memorable situation in one of the following poems.
- *It is a beauteous evening, calm and free* by William Wordsworth
 - *A Hard Frost* by Cecil Day-Lewis

Or

- 18 Choose **one** of the following poems and explore how the writing brings out emotions in you.
- *Sometimes It Happens* by Brian Patten
 - *The Wife of Usher's Well* by Anonymous

TURN OVER FOR SECTION C

SECTION C: PROSE

Answer **one** question from this section.

HARPER LEE: *To Kill A Mockingbird*

Either

- *19** In what ways does this passage bring out feelings of outrage and tension for you? Support your answer with close reference to the passage.

‘Robinson, you’re pretty good at busting up chiffarobes and kindling with one hand, aren’t you?’

‘Yes suh, I reckon so.’

‘Strong enough to choke the breath out of a woman and sling her to the floor?’

‘I never done that, suh.’

5

‘But you are strong enough to?’

‘I reckon so, suh.’

‘Had your eye on her a long time, hadn’t you, boy?’

‘No suh, I never looked at her.’

‘Then you were mighty polite to do all that chopping and hauling for her, weren’t you boy?’

10

‘I was just tryin’ to help her out, suh.’

‘That was mighty generous of you, you had chores at home after your regular work, didn’t you?’

‘Yes suh.’

15

‘Why didn’t you do them instead of Miss Ewell’s?’

‘I done ’em both, suh.’

‘You must have been pretty busy. Why?’

‘Why what, suh?’

‘Why were you so anxious to do that woman’s chores?’

20

Tom Robinson hesitated, searching for an answer. ‘Looked like she didn’t have nobody to help her, like I says –’

‘With Mr Ewell and seven children on the place, boy?’

‘Well, I says it looked like they never help her none –’

‘You did all this chopping and work from sheer goodness, boy?’

25

‘Tried to help her, I says.’

Mr Gilmer smiled grimly at the jury. ‘You’re a mighty good fellow, it seems – did all this for not one penny?’

‘Yes suh. I felt right sorry for her, she seemed to try more’n the rest of ’em –’

‘*You felt sorry* for her, you felt *sorry* for her?’ Mr Gilmer seemed ready to rise to the ceiling.

30

The witness realized his mistake and shifted uncomfortably in the chair. But the damage was done. Below us, nobody liked Tom Robinson’s answer. Mr Gilmer paused a long time to let it sink in.

‘Now you went by the house as usual, last November twenty-first,’ he said, ‘and she asked you to come in and bust up a chiffarobe?’

35

‘No suh.’

‘Do you deny that you went by the house?’

‘No suh, she said she had somethin’ for me to do inside the house –’

‘She says she asked you to bust up a chiffarobe, is that right?’

40

‘No suh, it aint.’

‘Then you say she’s lying, boy?’

Atticus was on his feet, but Tom Robinson didn’t need him. ‘I don’t say she’s lyin’, Mr Gilmer, I say she’s mistaken in her mind.’

To the next ten questions, as Mr Gilmer reviewed Mayella's version of events, the witness's steady answer was that she was mistaken in her mind. 45

'Didn't Mr Ewell run you off the place, boy?'

'No suh, I don't think he did.'

'Don't think, what do you mean?'

'I mean I didn't stay long enough for him to run me off.' 50

'You're very candid about this, why did you run so fast?'

'I says I was scared, suh.'

'If you had a clear conscience, why were you scared?'

Or

20 'How does Lee make you feel about Jem and Scout's relationship? Support your answer with close reference to the text.

Or

21 You are Mayella after the jury has passed a guilty verdict on Tom Robinson. Write your thoughts.

CHINUA ACHEBE: *Things Fall Apart*

Either

- *22 How do you think this passage creates fear and anxiety? Support your answer with close reference to the passage.

The next day, the men returned with a pot of wine. They were all fully dressed as if they were going to a big clan meeting or to pay a visit to a neighbouring village. They passed their cloths under the right arm-pit, and hung their goatskin bags and sheathed matchets over their left shoulders. Okonkwo got ready quickly and the party set out with Ikemefuna carrying the pot of wine. A deathly silence descended on Okonkwo's compound. Even the very little children seemed to know. Throughout that day Nwoye sat in his mother's hut and tears stood in his eyes.

5

At the beginning of their journey the men of Umuofia talked and laughed about the locusts, about their women, and about some effeminate men who had refused to come with them. But as they drew near to the outskirts of Umuofia silence fell upon them too.

10

The sun rose slowly to the centre of the sky, and the dry, sandy footway began to throw up the heat that lay buried in it. Some birds chirruped in the forests around. The men trod dry leaves on the sand. All else was silent. Then from the distance came the faint beating of the *ekwe*. It rose and faded with the wind – a peaceful dance from a distant clan.

15

'It is an ozo dance,' the men said among themselves. But no one was sure where it was coming from. Some said Ezimili, others Abame or Aninta. They argued for a short while and fell into silence again, and the elusive dance rose and fell with the wind. Somewhere a man was taking one of the titles of his clan, with music and dancing and a great feast.

20

The footway had now become a narrow line in the heart of the forest. The short trees and sparse undergrowth which surrounded the men's village began to give way to giant trees and climbers which perhaps had stood from the beginning of things, untouched by the axe and the bush-fire. The sun breaking through their leaves and branches threw a pattern of light and shade on the sandy footway.

25

Ikemefuna heard a whisper close behind him and turned round sharply. The man who had whispered now called out aloud, urging the others to hurry up.

'We still have a long way to go,' he said. Then he and another man went before Ikemefuna and set a faster pace.

Thus the men of Umuofia pursued their way, armed with sheathed matchets, and Ikemefuna, carrying a pot of palm-wine on his head, walked in their midst. Although he had felt uneasy at first, he was not afraid now. Okonkwo walked behind him. He could hardly imagine that Okonkwo was not his real father. He had never been fond of his real father, and at the end of three years he had become very distant indeed. But his mother and his three-year-old sister ... of course she would not be three now, but six.

30

35

Would he recognize her now? She must have grown quite big. How his mother would weep for joy, and thank Okonkwo for having looked after him so well and for bringing him back. She would want to hear everything that had happened to him in all these years. Could he remember them all? He would tell her about Nwoye and his mother, and about the locusts.... Then quite suddenly a thought came upon him. His mother might be dead. He tried in vain to force the thought out of his mind. Then he tried to settle the matter the way he used to settle such matters when he was a little boy. He still remembered the song:

40

Eze elina, elina!

Sala

45

Eze ilikwa ya

Ikwaba akwa oligholi

Ebe Danda nechi eze

Ebe Uzuzu nete egwu

Sala

50

He sang it in his mind, and walked to its beat. If the song ended on his right foot, his mother was alive. If it ended on his left, she was dead. No, not dead, but ill. It ended on the right. She was alive and well. He sang the song again, and it ended on the left. But the second time did not count. The first voice gets to Chukwu, or God's house. That was a favourite saying of children. Ikemefuna felt like a child once more. It must be the thought of going home to his mother.

55

One of the men behind him cleared his throat. Ikemefuna looked back, and the man growled at him to go on and not stand looking back. The way he said it sent cold fear down Ikemefuna's back. His hands trembled vaguely on the black pot he carried. Why had Okonkwo withdrawn to the rear? Ikemefuna felt his legs melting under him. And he was afraid to look back.

60

As the man who had cleared his throat drew up and raised his matchet, Okonkwo looked away. He heard the blow. The pot fell and broke in the sand. He heard Ikemefuna cry, 'My father, they have killed me!' as he ran towards him. Dazed with fear, Okonkwo drew his matchet and cut him down. He was afraid of being thought weak.

65

Or

- 23 What do you think makes Obierika such a memorable character in this novel? Support your answer with close reference to the text.

Or

- 24 You are Ekwefi after Okonkwo has nearly shot you. Write your thoughts.

BARRIE WADE (ed.): *Into the Wind: Contemporary Stories in English*

Either

- *25 In what ways do you think Doris Lessing's writing in this passage from *A Woman on a Roof* creates tension and makes you feel pity for Tom? Support your answer with close reference to the passage.

On the pavement Stanley said: 'I'm going home.' He looked white now, so perhaps he really did have sunstroke. Harry went off to find the foreman who was at work on the plumbing of some flats down the street. Tom slipped back, not into the building they had been working on, but the building on whose roof the woman lay. He went straight up, no one stopping him. The skylight stood open, with an iron ladder leading up. He emerged on to the roof a couple of yards from her. She sat up, pushing back her black hair with both hands. The scarf across her breasts bound them tight, and brown flesh bulged around it. Her legs were brown and smooth. She stared at him in silence. The boy stood grinning, foolish, claiming the tenderness he expected from her.

5

'What do you want?' she asked.

10

'I ... I came to ... make your acquaintance,' he stammered, grinning, pleading with her.

They looked at each other, the slight, scarlet-faced excited boy, and the serious, nearly-naked woman. Then without a word, she lay face down on her brown blanket, ignoring him.

15

'You like the sun, do you?' he enquired of her glistening back.

Not a word. He felt panic, thinking of how she had held him in her arms, stroked his hair, brought him where he sat, lordly, in her bed, a glass of some exhilarating liquor he had never tasted in life. He felt that if he knelt down, stroked her shoulders, her hair, she would turn and clasp him in her arms.

20

He said: 'The sun's all right for you, isn't it.'

She raised her head, set her chin on two small fists. 'Go away,' she said. He did not move. 'Listen,' she said, in a slow reasonable voice, where anger was kept in check, though with difficulty; looking at him, her face weary with anger: 'If you get a kick out of seeing women in bikinis, why don't you take a sixpenny bus ride to the Lido? You'd see dozens of them, without all this mountaineering.'

25

She hadn't understood him. He felt her unfairness pale him. He stammered: 'But I like you, I've been watching you and ...'

'Thanks,' she said, and dropped her face again, turned away from him.

She lay there. He stood there. She said nothing. She had simply shut him out. He stood, saying nothing at all, for some minutes. He thought: She'll have to say something if I stay. But the minutes went past, with no sign of them in her, except in the tension of her back, her thighs, her arms, – the tension of waiting for him to go.

30

He looked up at the sky, where the sun seemed to spin in heat: and over the roofs where he and his mates had been earlier. He could see the heat quivering where they had worked. And they expect us to work in these conditions! he thought, filled with righteous indignation. The woman hadn't moved. A bit of hot wind blew her black hair softly, it shone, and was iridescent. He remembered how he had stroked it last night.

35

Resentment of her at last moved him off and away down the ladder, through the building, into the street. He got drunk then, in hatred of her.

40

Next day when he woke the sky was grey. He looked at the wet and thought viciously: Well that's fixed you, hasn't it now? That's fixed you good and proper.

The three men were at work early on the cool leads, surrounded by damp drizzling roofs where no one came to sun themselves, black roofs, slimy with rain. Because it was cool now, they would finish the job that day, if they hurried.

45

Or

- 26 How do you think Cyprian Ekwensi's portrayal of the Stranger in *A Stranger from Lagos* makes him an interesting and pitiable character? Support your answer with close reference to the text.

Or

- 27 You are the hitch-hiker in *The Hitch-hiker*. You have just stolen the book of tickets in which the policeman has written details about the driver's traffic offence and the black book which has your personal details. Write your thoughts.

